

AI Tool Selection Guide for Engineering Work

Choose the right tool for each task type

Chat Interfaces (Claude.ai, ChatGPT, Gemini)

General Q&A
Drafting documents
Explaining concepts
Brainstorming

*Flexible, conversational
Good for exploration
Easy to iterate*

NotebookLM (Google)

Research synthesis
Source-grounded answers
Podcast generation
Multi-document analysis

*Cites sources directly
Reduces hallucination
Great for learning*

Claude Code (CLI Tool)

Code development
File operations
Project automation
Technical implementation

*Edits real files
Runs commands
Project-aware context*

Browser Extensions (Claude, etc.)

Web page analysis
Quick questions
Content summarization
In-context assistance

*Works in browser
No context switching
Immediate access*